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WE CONNECT YOUR BRAND TO TODAY'S CONNECTED CONSUMERS

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RAKUTEN REWARDS, TIKTOK INFLUENCER CAMPAIGNS

Rakuten

Rakuten became a client for M&C Saatchi Performance in 2021. The original brief was to drive incremental app installs and new member sign-ups to Rakuten Rewards but with 70% of users on iOS, Rakuten needed to identify channels that would continue to reach its core audience while still being able to measure success around iOS 14.5+ limitations.

Rakuten is one of the leading Cash Back and shopping rewards apps in the US. Members can access over 3,500 retailers across every shopping category, including big brands like Nike, Adidas, Sephora, ULTA Beauty, Levi's, Calvin Klein, Ray-Ban, and more. The app is easy to use – customers simply click through retailers on the Rakuten app and then shop on the stores' websites, Cash Back is applied to purchases at checkout. Membership is free and new members can receive a $10 welcome bonus after placing a qualifying purchase within the first 90 days.

In 2021, a new Influencer Performance Marketing division at M&C Saatchi Performance was established to help clients such as Rakuten Rewards harness the power of content creators via performance media channels. The team approaches working with influencers and content creators strategically, with influencers being used as an advocate for a brand, while content creators can be leveraged for rapid production of content for both paid and owned channels (see slide 4 for more).

Initially we proposed influencer campaigns on TikTok specifically as a way of reaching new audiences through a native format that would resonate with the community. The influencer approach has proven so successful that it became an evergreen performance media strategy for the brand. The M&C Saatchi Performance team are now so trusted, they create new approaches based on seasonality and trends seen on TikTok to continue keeping the brand relevant even during times when consumer spending may be low.

For example, with the cost of living on the rise, we recognised that harnessing TikTok to showcase easy money saving shopping hacks would help consumers.

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Results: campaign dates February to October 2022

CONTEXT:

RAKUTEN TIKTOK CAMPAIGN APPROACH

OBJECTIVE

Position Rakuten as the leading Cash Back and rewards app in the US, driving incremental app installs and new member sign-ups.

THE CHALLENGE

With the rising cost of most everyday items, everyone is looking to reduce their monthly spending on essentials for themselves and their families.

THE STRATEGY

Identified and partnered with 39 micro to macro influencers on TikTok whose content represented various shopping categories on the app – e.g. fashion, beauty, groceries, pets, etc.

With inflation top of mind, we wanted influencers to share with the community a savvy way to shop and save money without having to change where people shopped. Some videos highlighted essential stores to drive more usage around everyday necessities, including pet supplies.

To measure app installs, Spark ads were launched for iOS to allow users to easily click through to the App Store and convert. We also partnered with content creators (UGC actors) who helped generate additional videos that ran in the paid media campaign.

Results: campaign dates February to October 2022

RECAP: WHY USE CONTENT CREATORS AND INFLUENCERS?

INFLUENCE

Influencers are best used when the goal is to reach a specific audience through the voice of the creator. The partnership helps to drive awareness and trust by leveraging their equity, thus, influencing their audience.

REACH

A single post has the potential to reach millions of people who subscribe or follow an account. Whether the goal is mass media coverage or reaching a niche audience, creators are like any other media publisher.

CONTENT CREATION

Content creators can be an efficient resource for generating assets on organic and paid channels using the expertise of the creator, allowing for brands to experiment with different types of content and produce ads that appear more native.

CHOOSING THE RIGHT INFLUENCERS

Celebrity influencers are some of the most recognizable people living in the public eye and can include those who have gained popularity through social media. This group is the most expensive but has the greatest reach.

Smaller influencers have the potential to reach niche audiences, tend to see higher engagement rates, and are more cost effective.

At M&C Saatchi Performance, we believe finding the right partnerships means looking beyond the size of a following and customizing our approach based on a brand's objective.

CELEBRITY
1.5M+

MACRO
500k-1.5M

MID-TIER
100-500k

MICRO
10k-100k

NANO
< 10k

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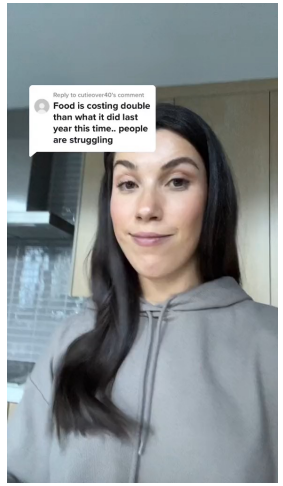
INFLUENCER EXAMPLES

@nutritiouslyeasy



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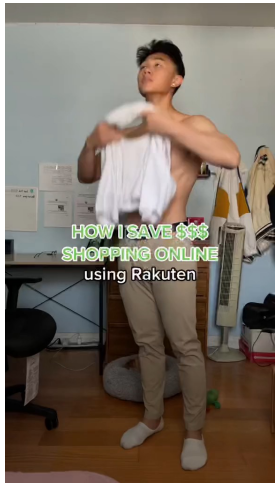

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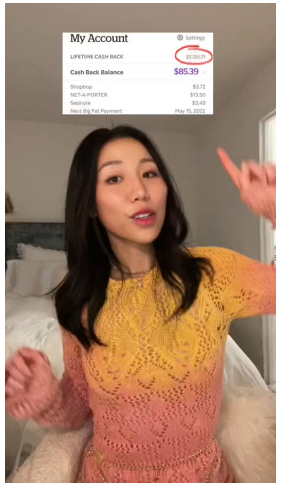

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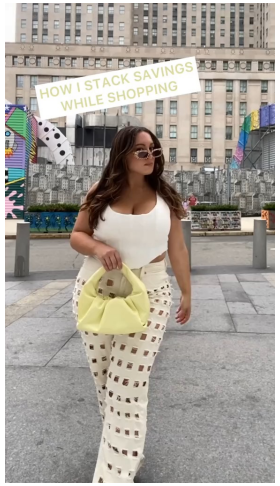
@gamjamypotato

@bellagerard



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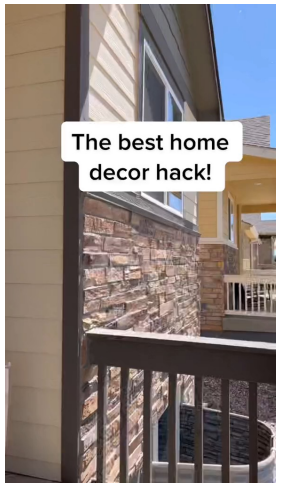
@byjamiemichelle



Video Views: February 15 – October 26, 2022
Results: March 1 – October 23, 2022

INFLUENCER RESULTS

Rakuten

39MM

VIDEO VIEWS

634K

LIKES

-7%*

LOWER COST PER INSTALL GOAL

-5%*

LOWER COST PER SIGNUP

*Consistently outperforming pre-iOS 14.5 CPI and CPA Goals on SKAdNetwork

Video Views: February 15 – October 26, 2022 Results: March 1 – October 23, 2022

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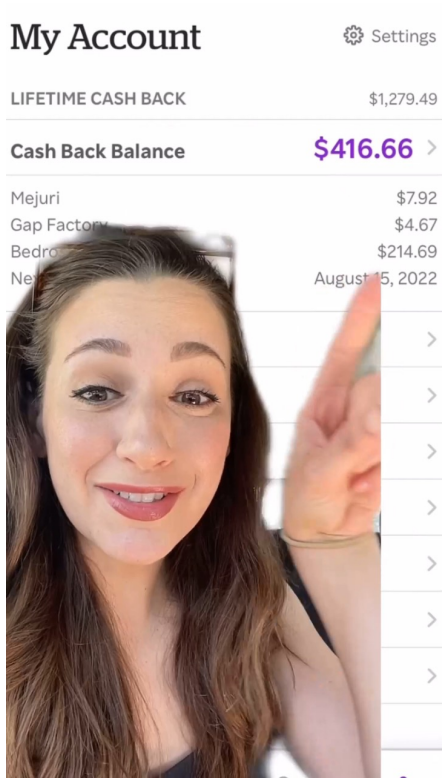
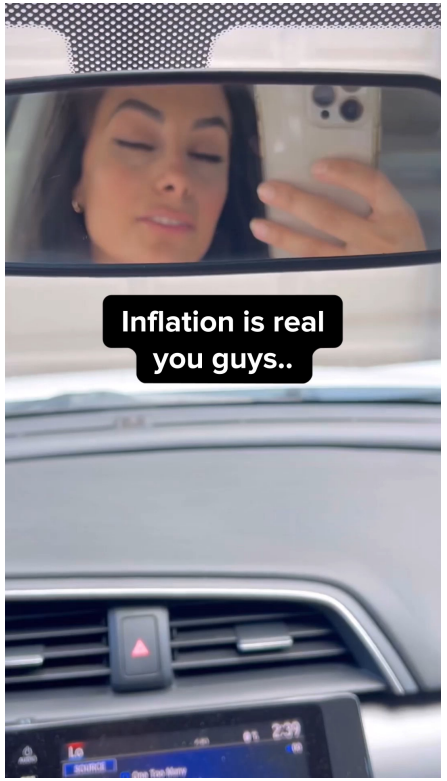
CONTENT CREATOR EXAMPLES





Results: August 2 – September 30, 2022

CONTENT CREATOR RESULTS

Client testimonials:

”M&C Saatchi Performance are an amazing team. Fast, thorough, responsive- Thank you!” Senior Manager

“The team are great to work with! They're always forward-thinking with strategies and recommendations, keeping Rakuten's goals top of mind.” Senior Manager

Rakuten

2MM

VIDEO VIEWS

-2%*

COST PER SIGNUP GOAL

-10%*

COST PER INSTALL GOAL

VIDEOS DELIVERED AGAINST THE IOS CPI GOAL WITHIN 1 WEEK

Results: August 2 – September 30, 2022

*Consistently outperforming pre-iOS 14.5 CPI and CPA goals on SKAdNetwork

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TALK TO US

Contact us for more information

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